make sense of what was to transpire between August and December 2019. During this momentous period, Bharat witnessed the following:

1. Amendments were undertaken to Articles 367 and 370 of the Constitution on 5 and 6 August 2019, and the erstwhile State of Jammu and Kashmir was reorganised into two Union Territories with effect from 31 October 2019.
2. A Constitution Bench of the Supreme Court led by the then Chief Justice of India, Shri Ranjan Gogoi, pronounced a unanimous verdict on 9 November 2019 affirming the ownership of the Deity Shri Ram Lalla over His birthplace in Ayodhya, thereby validating a 500-year-old Indic civilisational and religious movement to reclaim Shri Ram Janmabhoomi.
3. The Citizenship Amendment Act, 2019 ('the CAA') was promulgated on 12 December 2019, which provided an accelerated access to citizenship for persecuted Hindus, Sikhs, Buddhists, Jains, Parsis and Christians from Muslim-majority countries, such as Pakistan, Bangladesh and Afghanistan.

Each of these developments generated significant debate, which was natural given that these were tectonic shifts in Indian history, that touched upon quite a few fault lines and unresolved legacy and civilisational issues. That said, the most troubling aspect of these debates, which kept rearing its head over and over again, was that the very legitimacy and the underlying identity of the Indian State and the Indic society were called into question.

We were being told that Bharat was a synthetic product of colonisation, which had no identity or consciousness of its own before the European coloniser set foot on its soil and stitched it together as one 'nation'. Arguments that were allegedly rooted in the Constitution were being marshalled to support these positions, which effectively turned the Constitution into a battleground of sorts. The extent of the divide was such that I was told on social media that the use of 'Bharat' for India was bigoted and against the Constitution's promise of secularism. The fact that Article 1 of the Constitution expressly began with '*India, that is Bharat.…*' to declare its roots and heritage to the world was barely known, and even if it was known, the significance of the use of 'Bharat' in the very first Article of the document appeared to have been lost over time. That is when I